

# Editor Guide

## Copernicus Land Monitoring Service - Technical Library



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Date: **2026-05-26**

Version: **1.2.0**

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## i Note

This guide assumes your project is already integrated with the Technical Library - the `docs/` subtree is in place and the Git aliases are configured. If that setup isn't done yet, see the [Setup Guide](#) first.

# 1. How This Works

## 1.1 Your project and the central library

Your project repository contains a `docs/` folder that is both part of your project and part of the central CLMS Technical Library. The connection works as a **git subtree**: your documents live in your repo, but `git docs-publish` merges them into the library's `develop` branch.

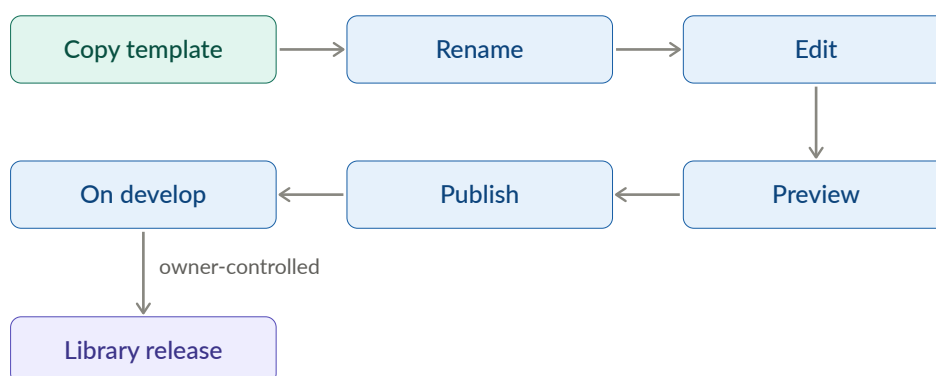
That means you own the source. You edit locally, commit to your project, and publish when ready. The library pulls in documents from all projects.

## 1.2 The publish flow

Publishing to `develop` is not a public release. The public-facing library only changes when a Technical Library owner promotes changes from `develop` to `test` to `main`. As an editor, your work stops at `develop`.



## 1.3 The document lifecycle



Major version bumps are your decision - you create a new file with a bumped `_v<N>` suffix. Minor and patch versions are AI-assigned at release time based on the scope of changes.

## 2. Starting a New Document

### 2.1 From a template (recommended)

Pick the template that matches your document type:

- `CLMS_Template_ATBD.qmd` - Algorithm Theoretical Basis Document, for the scientific and technical foundations of a data product
- `CLMS_Template_PUM.qmd` - Product User Manual, for how users access and interpret a product

Once you've chosen:

1. Copy the template into `DOCS/` (not sure what that looks like? See [Folder and File Structure](#))
2. Rename it using this pattern: `CLMS_<Product-Name>_<Document-Type>_v<Major-Version>.qmd`

For example: `CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v1.qmd`

Use hyphens within the product name, not underscores. Start every new document at `_v1`. The document type is either `ATBD` or `PUM`.

3. Create a matching `-media/` folder for images: `CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v1-media/`
4. Edit in place, following the structure the template provides

The templates include a pre-filled YAML header, required sections, and commented guidance throughout. Try to keep the structure intact - it makes a real difference to how consistently documents behave across the library.

### 2.2 From scratch

If neither template fits, create a new `.qmd` file directly in `DOCS/`, following the same naming pattern, create a matching `-media/` folder, and add the required YAML header manually (see [The YAML Header](#)).

#### Tip

Templates save time even when they don't feel like an exact fit - the YAML header and section structure are the main things you'd otherwise need to set up manually.

Migrating an existing `.docx`? See the Migration Guide [TBD link].

## 3. The YAML Header

If you copied a template, the header is pre-filled - just update `title`, `subtitle`, `date`, and `product-name`.

### 3.1 Required fields

```
---
title: "HRL Forest"
subtitle: "High Resolution Layer - Forest Type"
category: products
date: "2026-01-27"
---
```

- `title` - short product name, appears as the document title

- `subtitle` - full product name or document type description
- `category` - one of `products`, `guidelines`, `reports`, `uncategorized`, `non-browsable`
- `date` - publication or last-updated date in ISO format

## 3.2 Optional fields

- `type` - how the document is built. Leave it out for ordinary documents. Set `type: dashboard` for an interactive page: it renders to HTML only - no PDF, no table of contents, no version or changelog. New types are added by a Technical Library owner.
- `product-name` - used internally for metadata and indexing
- `template-version` - records which template version was used as the starting point. Set automatically when copying a template; don't edit it manually.

## 3.3 System-managed fields

Leave these out of your YAML header entirely - the publishing system handles them:

- `keywords` - AI-generated at publish time based on document content. Anything you add gets overwritten.
- `version` - carried by the filename suffix, not the YAML. No version field belongs in the header.

# 4. Writing Content

Markdown basics - headings, lists, links, images, tables, equations, footnotes, diagrams - are covered in the [Quarto Markdown guide](#). This chapter covers only what's specific to this system.

## 4.1 Image folder convention

Images go in `<your-document-name>-media/`, referenced with relative paths:

```
![[Processing workflow]](CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2-media/workflow.png)
```

## 4.2 Page breaks

Use the Quarto shortcode to insert a page break in PDF output:

```
{{< pagebreak >}}
```

Note that `---` renders as a horizontal rule, not a page break.

## 4.3 Complex table layouts

For tables with merged cells, nested content, or custom styling, use HTML tables directly in your `.qmd` file. Both the HTML output and Typst-rendered PDF handle them well.

Standard Markdown tables have limited formatting options. HTML tables let you control exactly how things look - column widths, cell colours, text alignment, borders - using inline CSS:

```
```{=html}
<table style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;">
  <thead>
    <tr style="background-color: #2c3e50; color: white;">
```

```
<th colspan="2" style="padding: 10px; text-align: center;">Product Overview</th>
</tr>
</thead>
<tbody>
<tr>
<td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc; font-weight: bold;">HRL Forest</td>
<td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc;">Active</td>
</tr>
<tr style="background-color: #f2f2f2;">
<td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc; font-weight: bold;">Water Bodies</td>
<td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc;">Active</td>
</tr>
</tbody>
</table>
...
```

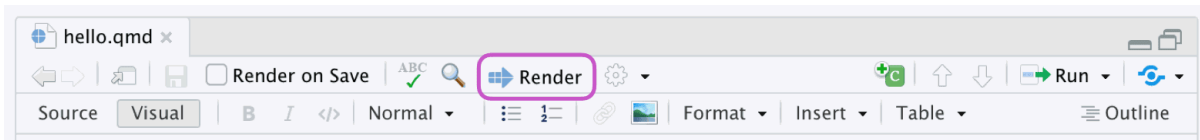
## 5. Editing and Previewing Locally

### 5.1 Open the project in RStudio

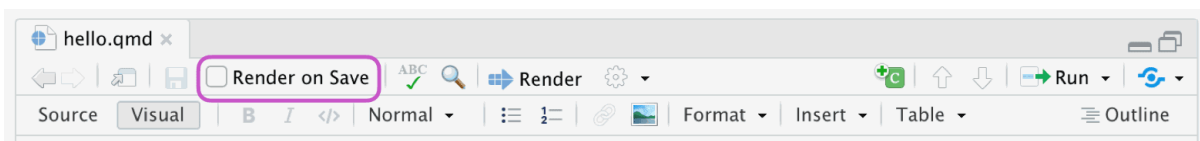
1. Open RStudio
2. **File > Open Project...** and select the root folder of your project
3. Navigate to `DOCS/` and open the `.qmd` file you want to edit

### 5.2 Preview your document

Click the **Render** button at the top of the editor pane to render HTML or PDF:



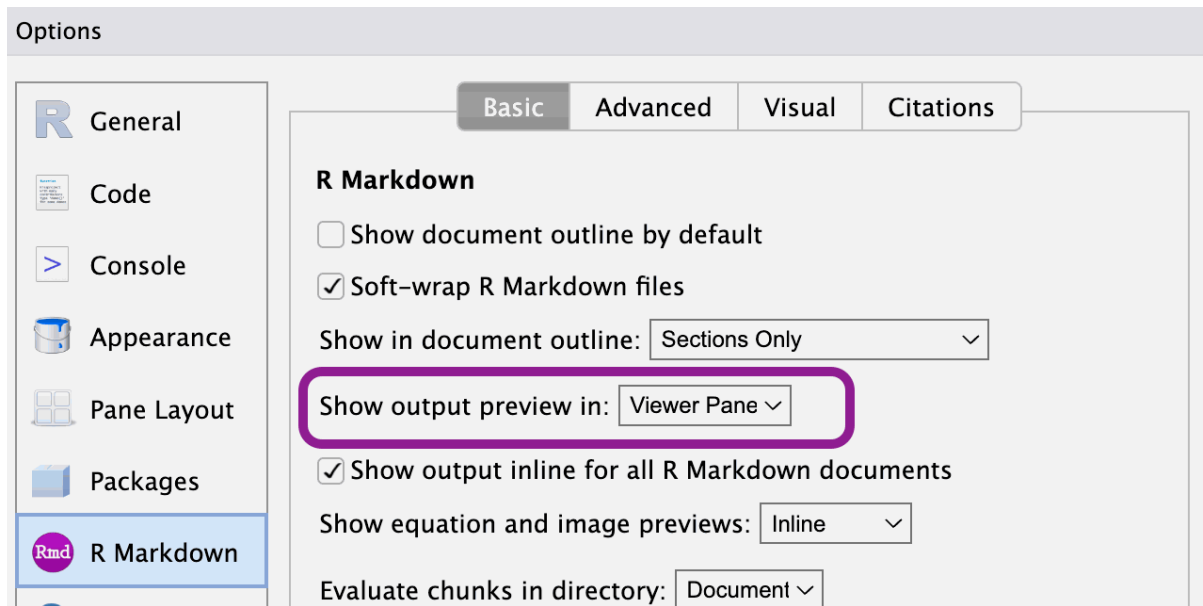
Or enable **Preview on Save** in the toolbar to re-render on every save:



The rendered output appears in the **Viewer** tab in the lower-right pane:



If the Viewer tab isn't showing rendered output, go to **Tools > Global Options > R Markdown** and set **Show output preview in** to **Viewer Pane**:



## 5.3 Render the full project

To render all documents and preview the complete library locally:

```
git docs-preview
```

### 💡 Tip

The repository ships with the project config renamed to `_quarto-not-used.yaml` so RStudio operates in single-file mode by default - faster for day-to-day editing. When you need to render the full project, rename it to `_quarto.yaml`, run `quarto render`, then rename it back.

## 6. Publishing to Develop

```
git add DOCS/  
git commit -m "docs: update [brief description]"  
git docs-publish
```

After the pipeline runs, check your document at: [https://eea.github.io/CLMS\\_documents/develop/index.html](https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/develop/index.html)

Navigation, cross-links, and the sidebar TOC can behave differently than in your local RStudio preview - worth a quick look before calling it done.

## 7. Folder and File Structure

```
DOCS/  
├── _meta/                # Scripts, config, metadata - do not edit  
├── includes/             # Quarto include files - do not edit  
└── ...
```

```
|— templates/                # Document templates - do not edit
|— theme/                   # Styling definitions - do not edit
|— _quarto.yml              # Project-wide Quarto config
|— CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd
|— CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2-media/
|— CLMS_Water-Bodies_ATBD_v1.qmd
|— CLMS_Water-Bodies_ATBD_v1-media/
|— ...
```

Your work lives in `DOCS/` directly: one `.qmd` file per document, plus a matching `-media/` folder for images and diagrams. The four managed subdirectories (`_meta/`, `includes/`, `templates/`, `theme/`) are updated centrally - don't edit them.

## 8. File Naming and Versioning

### 8.1 The version suffix

The `_v<N>` suffix in the filename is the major version - the only version number you control. Minor and patch versions are assigned automatically by AI at library release time based on the scope of changes: small corrections get a patch bump (2.3.5 → 2.3.6), new or revised sections get a minor bump (2.3.0 → 2.4.0). A new file `CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v3.qmd` starts at 3.0.0 at its first release. You never set a version number in YAML.

### 8.2 When to create a new major version

Edit the existing file for most changes. Create a new major version only when you need to:

- rewrite most of the content
- make breaking structural changes
- keep the previous version available as a stable reference

```
cp DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v3.qmd
cp -r DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2-media DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v3-media
```

Both versions stay in the library and evolve independently from that point on.

### 8.3 Don't rename after publishing

The filename becomes part of the document's URL. Renaming breaks links and cross-references. If a significant revision is needed, create a new major version rather than renaming.

## 9. Restoring Previous Versions

Restore pulls a published version of a document into your local working copy. It doesn't roll back the library - think of it as "pick up from version X," not "undo to version X."

### 9.1 Commands

```
git docs-restore --list-all          # all published documents
git docs-restore --list DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd  # versions of one file
```

```
git docs-restore DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd 2.0.0      # specific version
git docs-restore --latest DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd  # latest published version
```

## 9.2 When to use it

**Recover deleted content.** You removed a section locally and need it back. Restore the last published version, copy out what you need, then carry on with your current version.

**Something went wrong in a recent edit.** Restore an earlier version (e.g. 2.1.0) and work forward from there rather than trying to untangle the current state.

**Resurrect a deleted file.** If a file was removed from the project but still exists in the library history, `--list-all` will find it. Restore brings it back into `DOCS/` as if nothing happened.

## 10. Release Path

Once you publish to `develop`, the rest of the process belongs to Technical Library owners. Getting from `develop` to public requires two separate pull requests, each reviewed and approved by a second owner before it merges.

| Stage         | URL                                                                                                                           |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| develop       | <a href="https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/develop/index.html">https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/develop/index.html</a> |
| test          | <a href="https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/test/index.html">https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/test/index.html</a>       |
| main (public) | <a href="https://library.land.copernicus.eu">https://library.land.copernicus.eu</a>                                           |

At each release, the system assigns version numbers automatically based on what changed.

## 11. Change Log

| Date       | Version | Summary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026-06-03 | 1.2.0   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Major restructuring and rewrite of the manual to focus on practical editing aspects for the CLMS Technical Library.</li><li>Updated document title to 'Editor Guide' and revised its description.</li><li>Removed extensive sections on Quarto and Markdown basics, software installation, detailed rendering, and troubleshooting.</li><li>Added new simplified sections on document lifecycle, publishing flow, folder and file structure, naming conventions, versioning, and restoring previous versions.</li><li>Updated the document date.</li></ul> |
| 2026-02-10 | 1.1.0   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Extended explanation for <code>`git docs-restore`</code> functionality.</li><li>Added major version upgrade process explanation.</li><li>Added more precise instructions.</li><li>Minor edits to wording in various sections.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 2025-12-03 | 1.0.0   | Initial release                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |